

CASE ID: 201706710002

EPISODE NAME: US Taiwan Arms Sales 2017

2017/06/30 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: End Weapons/Materials Proliferation (9)

Final Outcome: Stalemate in the Threat Stage (4)

Summary:

In response to a 2017/06/29 \$1.42 billion USD arms sale to Taiwan by the US, China threatened to impose diplomatic and economic sanctions on the US on 2017/06/30. China did not impose sanctions.

Narrative:

On 2017/06/30, China threatened the United States with diplomatic and economic sanctions in retaliation for arms sales to Taiwan.¹ China considers Taiwan to be part of its territory. China had previously threatened sanctions against U.S. companies for arms sales to Taiwan during Obama's term.²

The episode began on 2017/06/29, when the U.S. announced a \$1.42 billion arms sale to Taiwan.³ The sale included weapons, such as torpedoes, missiles, and early-warning radar systems, that aimed to modernize Taiwan's defense capabilities.⁴ In response, Chinese foreign ministry spokesman Lu Kan said that the country "oppose[ed] any external interference" in Chinese international affairs, and that the sale would damage bilateral relations.⁵

Although the arms sale occurred, China never followed through on the ambiguous and weakly-committed threat. However, later arms sales did produce retaliation, and these sanctions are still in effect.⁶

¹ Tang, Didi, and Jennings, Ralph. "China strongly protests US arms sales to Taiwan." *AP News*, June 30th, 2017. <https://apnews.com/article/47dde9fadeea4c1ba656d88e210dda9c>.

² "China Warns Against First Major US-Taiwan Arms Sale in Four Years." *The Guardian*, December 16th, 2015.

www.theguardian.com/us-news/2015/dec/16/china-warns-against-us-taiwan-arms-sale-defence.

³ Tang, Didi, and Jennings, Ralph. "China strongly protests US arms sales to Taiwan." *AP News*, June 30th, 2017. <https://apnews.com/article/47dde9fadeea4c1ba656d88e210dda9c>.

⁴ Harris, Gardiner. "U.S., Hardening Line on China, Approves \$1 Billion Arms Sale to Taiwan." June 29th, 2017. <https://www.nytimes.com/2017/06/29/us/politics/trump-china-weapons-taiwan.html>.

⁵ Tang, Didi, and Jennings, Ralph. "China strongly protests US arms sales to Taiwan." *AP News*, June 30th, 2017. <https://apnews.com/article/47dde9fadeea4c1ba656d88e210dda9c>.

⁶ "Decision on Taking Countermeasures Against U.S. Military Companies and Senior Executives." *The Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China*, 10 October 2024, www.mfa.gov.cn/mfa_eng/xw/wjbxw/202410/t20241011_11505419.html.